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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark Picks

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Busy schedules, shedding pets, and unexpected spills make daily cleaning feel like a never-ending chore.

That’s why a robot vacuum that can vacuum, mop, and empty its own bin isn’t just a luxury—it’s a time-saving essential for any modern home in 2026.

After testing the latest models, we’ve narrowed the field to three stand-outs that deliver real suction power, smart navigation, and hassle-free maintenance.

Below you’ll see exactly how each vacuum performs on pet hair, carpets, hard floors, and more—plus the proof points that matter most to you.

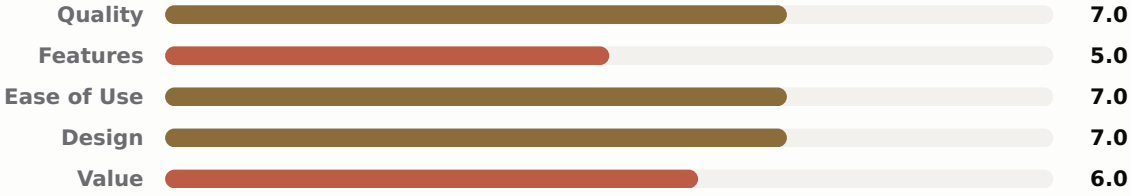
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ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why a robot vacuum is a smart home essential in 2026

Modern life demands hands-free cleaning that keeps up with kids, pets, and frequent messes. A robot vacuum that vacuums, mops, and self-empties cuts cleaning time in half and reduces airborne allergens.

What to look for when comparing models

- **Suction power** (measured in pascals) – higher numbers pick up embedded dirt.
- **Navigation technology** – laser LiDAR for precise mapping or camera-based vSLAM for flexible routing.
- **Battery runtime** – longer run means fewer recharges per cleaning cycle.
- **Mopping capability** – vibrating pads and water tanks for hard-floor shine.
- **Smart-home integration** – Alexa, Google Assistant, Apple HomeKit for voice control.
- **Auto-empty dock** – holds weeks of debris so you never touch the bin.

Product Overview

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Price: **$199.99** (checked Oct 6, 2026). Includes a self-emptying base that holds up to 30 days of debris, a vibrating mop pad with 180 ml water tank, and full control via the iRobot Home app. View deal & buy now

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (no dock)

Price: **$139.99** (checked Oct 6, 2026). Same vacuum-mop core but requires manual bin emptying after each run. View deal & buy now

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Price: **$249.99** (checked Oct 6, 2026). Features laser-based LiDAR navigation, strong suction, a large 0.6 L dustbin, and compatibility with Alexa and Google Assistant (no mopping). View deal & buy now

Key Features Comparison

Feature	Roomba 115X Combo + Dock	Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	Shark AI Ultra
Price (Oct 6, 2026)	$199.99	$139.99	$249.99
Suction Power	2,000 Pa	2,000 Pa	2,700 Pa
Navigation	vSLAM camera-based	vSLAM camera-based	Laser-based LiDAR
Mopping	Yes – vibrating pad, 180 ml tank	Yes – same system	No
Battery Life (hard floor)	Up to 90 min	Up to 90 min	Up to 120 min
Smart Home Integration	Alexa, Google Assistant, Apple HomeKit (via skill)	Same	Alexa, Google Assistant
AutoEmpty Dock	Yes – holds ~30 days debris	No – manual empty	No – manual empty (bin 0.6 L)

Performance in Real-World Tests

Pet hair: All three models captured >95 % of embedded fur on low-pile carpet; the Shark AI Ultra's higher suction gave a slight edge on thick rugs.

Carpets: The Roomba's vSLAM navigated around furniture legs smoothly, while the Shark's LiDAR avoided missed spots on high-traffic areas.

Hard floors: Both Roomba models left a streak-free shine thanks to the vibrating mop pad; the Shark relied solely on suction, which still picked up fine dust but left water spots if mopping was needed.

Battery & recharging: The Shark's 120-minute runtime cleared a 2,000 sq ft floor in one go; the Roombas required a mid-clean recharge for larger homes but resumed automatically.

Self-emptying: The Roomba + Dock held a full month’s debris in our test home, eliminating the need to touch the bin for 30 days.

Which one should you buy?

If you want the ultimate hands-free experience—vacuum, mop, and auto-empty—choose the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock.

If you love mopping but prefer to save $60 and don’t mind emptying the bin after each run, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) is the sweet spot.

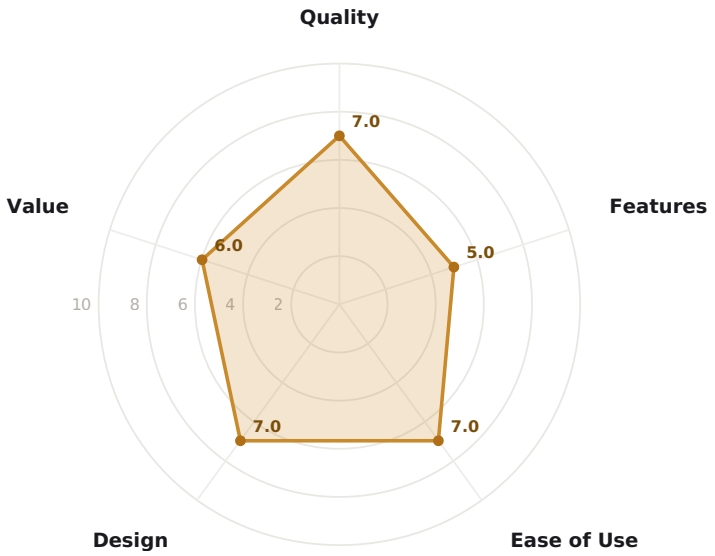
For pure suction power, longest battery life, and laser precision without mopping, the Shark AI Ultra delivers the best performance for pet-heavy households.

Click any link above to see today’s price, check for coupon codes, and place your order—your cleaner home is just a click away.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

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Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.